



# TEN MINUTES ON STAGE

SIX ROLES · EVERYBODY SPEAKS · NOBODY RUNS OVER

## 1 WHO DOES WHAT

*Write a real name in the last column.*

|                             |              |                                                                                    |             |
|-----------------------------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>1 THE OPENER</b>         | 0:00 – 0:40  | Name the person and ask the big question. No biography yet.                        | <i>name</i> |
| <b>2 THE STORY-TELLER</b>   | 0:40 – 2:40  | Five or six moments of the life, in order, all in the Past Simple, all with years. | <i>name</i> |
| <b>3 THE EVIDENCE-GIVER</b> | 2:40 – 5:00  | Your three criteria, and one thing Elizabeth did for each one. Year every time.    | <i>name</i> |
| <b>4 THE OTHER SIDE</b>     | 5:00 – 6:30  | What was <i>not</i> great. One or two real examples from the greatness test.       | <i>name</i> |
| <b>5 THE CLOSER</b>         | 6:30 – 8:00  | Your team's answer to WHAT MAKES A GREAT PERSON, and where Elizabeth lands on it.  | <i>name</i> |
| <b>6 THE QUESTION-TAKER</b> | 8:00 – 10:00 | Take questions from the room. You may ask the rest of the team to help.            | <i>name</i> |

## 2 REHEARSAL CHECKLIST

*One student holds this and ticks during the run.*

- |                                                                                |                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Every member of the team speaks.                      | <input type="checkbox"/> Three criteria, three pieces of evidence, in that order. |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Nobody speaks for longer than two and a half minutes. | <input type="checkbox"/> At least one honest point against your own person.       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> The big question is asked in the first minute.        | <input type="checkbox"/> The last sentence answers the big question directly.     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Every date is said out loud, not only shown.          | <input type="checkbox"/> You finish inside ten minutes.                           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Every fact about the past is in the Past Simple.      | <input type="checkbox"/> You look at the room, not at the paper.                  |

## 3 THE FIX LIST

*Three things. Three.*

### AFTER REHEARSAL 1 – THREE THINGS WE CHANGE (NOT FOUR)

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|  |
|  |
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## SENTENCE FRAMES – STEAL THESE

### OPENING

- Our person is Elizabeth the First, Queen of England from 1558 to 1603.
- Before we begin, one question: what makes a person great?
- Today we will give you our answer, and three pieces of evidence.

### TELLING THE STORY (PAST SIMPLE)

- She was born in 1533 at Greenwich Palace.
- In 1554 her sister sent her to the Tower of London.
- She became queen in 1558, when she was twenty-five.
- She did not marry, and she kept the power herself.

### GIVING EVIDENCE

- Our first criterion is courage. In 1588 she ...
- This shows that ...
- We chose this criterion because ...

### THE OTHER SIDE

- But not everything was great. In 1569 ...
- We have to say honestly that ...
- A great person is not a perfect person, and here is why that matters.

### CLOSING

- So our answer is: a person is great when ...
- Elizabeth meets two of our three criteria. The third one is harder.
- Thank you. We are ready for your questions.

### TAKING QUESTIONS

- That is a good question. Can I check – do you mean ...?
- I am not sure about the year. Maria, do you remember?
- We did not find that in our text, so I cannot answer it today.

### THE ONE RULE ABOUT THE PAST SIMPLE ON STAGE

Everything that happened before today is Past Simple: *she was, she became, she did not marry, did she marry?* Everything you think *now* is present: *we think, this shows, our answer is*. Mixing the two is the single mistake the room will hear.

### WHAT A TEN-MINUTE TALK IS NOT

It is not a Wikipedia page read out loud. The story of the life is two minutes of the ten. The other eight are your answer to the question, and the evidence for it.